Welcome to Speakaloud

Python Desktop PDF Reader & Rich Notepad (Powered by PyMuPDF)

1. Lightweight Architecture & Edge Highlighting

Speakaloud is built with Python and CustomTkinter, designed with zero Electron or Chromium browser bloat. It leverages PyMuPDF's C++ rendering core under the hood to display PDF pages instantly with authentic font kerning, sharp vector graphics, and clean margins. As audio plays, Speakaloud highlights the active sentence in a soft pastel blue and tracks each spoken word in real time in vibrant yellow.

2. Interactive Click-to-Play

You can click any word on this page right now! Speakaloud will immediately begin speaking from that exact word without jumping your view or shifting your scroll position. Try clicking words in different sentences below to experience instantaneous, precise seeking.

3. Smart Pronunciation & Regex Substitution Rules

Technical documentation and books frequently contain abbreviations, citation brackets, and corporate acronyms that sound clunky when read verbatim. Speakaloud uses a configurable speech rules engine to expand acronyms, strip silent citations, and pronounce abbreviations naturally:

- Acronym Expansion: The systems engineer configured the AMA service across our production Windows servers.

- Professional Titles: Dr. Smith and Prof. Davis coordinated with the CEO on the new cloud architecture.

- Academic Citations: Extensive clinical research [1, 2] demonstrates that auditory reading enhances focus.

- URLs & Abbreviations: Visit https://example.org/study for complete data e.g. charts, methodology, etc.

- Urgent Action Items: Please review this document and submit your questions ASAP vs. waiting until tomorrow.

Chapter 2: Rich Notepad & Dual Engines

Continuous Reading, Distraction-Free Drafting & Offline Neural Speech

4. Seamless Continuous Auto-Page Turning

Notice how the audio smoothly turned to Page Two without any manual clicking! When reading multi-page manuals, textbooks, or eBooks, Speakaloud automatically advances page by page so you can listen hands-free with headphones while multitasking.

5. Built-in Rich Text Notepad & Drafter

Need to draft an important email, review study notes, or paste articles from the web? Switch to the Notepad tab in the left sidebar. The editor supports rich formatting including Bold, Italics, Underline, Headings, and auto-continuing bullet lists. Simply click 'Read From Cursor' or double-click any word to hear your draft aloud. Listening to your text makes catching typos, grammatical slips, and awkward sentence cadence effortless.

6. Dual Neural Speech Engines

Speakaloud combines the flexibility of cloud and local speech:
- Microsoft Edge Cloud Voices: Over 320 natural neural voices across 80+ international languages with zero disk usage.
- Kokoro-82M Local Neural TTS: State-of-the-art offline AI speech running completely locally on your hardware.

7. Clean AppData Storage & Auto-Cache Pruning

Temporary audio clips are kept outside the project folder in %LocalAppData%\Speakaloud\cache and are automatically pruned in the background every three pages. This guarantees your storage never balloons beyond a few megabytes. Meanwhile, your bookmarks, reading positions, speech rules, and drafts are 100% preserved and isolated on each computer.